PROMOTIONAL DESIGN

OVERVIEW

Applying leadership and 21st century skills, participants use computerized graphic communications layout and design skills in the production of a promotional resource.

The resource is based on the annual theme posted on the TSA website under *Themes & Problems*. Semifinalists demonstrate competency through participation in an on-site technical design challenge.

ELIGIBILITY

Three (3) individuals per state may participate.

TIME LIMITS

PRE-CONFERENCE

A. All components of the chapter's entry (promotional design portfolio PDF) must be finished, submitted, and accessible via the Internet by 11:59 p.m. ET on a designated date in mid-May.

B. Entries received, or changes made to submitted entries after this deadline will not be judged.

SEMIFINAL ROUND

A. Fifteen (15) minutes is allowed to set up.

B. One (1) hour is allotted to complete, save, and submit the on-site challenge.

ATTIRE

TSA competition attire is required for this event.

PROCEDURE

PRE-CONFERENCE

A. Participants review the TSA Honor Statement for Competitive Events found in the General Rules.

B. Participants review the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) found in the General Rules.

C. Participants review the annual theme posted on the TSA website under *Themes & Problems*.

D. Participants concentrate their efforts toward creating promotional materials in order to satisfy the annual theme/problem through a four (4)-part marketing portfolio, in the form of a multipage pdf.

E. Promotional Design Portfolio. Participants submit the printable advertisement, wearable design, and digital marketing element as a multi-page PDF in the following order:

1. Title page
2. Item 1
3. Supporting documentation for required item 1
4. Item 2
5. Supporting documentation for required item 2
6. Item 3
7. Supporting documentation for required item 3
8. Item 4
9. Supporting documentation for required item 4
10. Copyright Information

F. All components of the chapter's entry (promotional design portfolio PDF) must be finished, submitted, and accessible via the Internet by 11:59 p.m. ET on a designated date in mid-May.

G. Submission information will be provided on the TSA website.

PRELIMINARY ROUND

A. Entries are independently reviewed by the judges prior to the conference.

B. A list of twelve (12) semifinalists (in random order) is posted on the first full day of conference.

SEMIFINAL ROUND

A. Semifinalists report at the time and place stated in the conference program with a laptop computer.

B. Semifinalists complete the on-site layout and design challenge within the one (1)-hour time limit.

C. Once semi-finalists complete their solution to the the design challenge, they will save their final entry as a PDF and submit their design solution using the submission procedures provided by the event coordinator.

D. Once the participant has submitted the solution, the participant may leave and take their computer out of the room.

E. Judges independently assess the entries without the student member present.

F. The top ten (10) finalists are announced during the conference awards ceremony.

REGULATIONS AND REQUIREMENTS

Students will work to develop their leadership and 21st century skills in the process of preparing for and participating in this TSA competitive event. The development and application of those skills must be evident in their submission, demonstration, and/or communication pertaining to the entry.

PRE-CONFERENCE

A. Required elements are posted on the TSA website under *Themes & Problems*.

B. Use of the TSA logo is permitted as long as it adheres to the current TSA Branding Guide.

C. Pre-conference, participants design four (4) components as part of the promotional design portfolio PDF based on the theme and requirements posted on the TSA website under *Themes & Problems*.

D. Supporting documentation must be included in the Promotional Design portfolio for each of the four (4) required items. Supporting documentation is limited to three (3) pages per item and must include the following information:

1. Explanation of how the design meets the challenge criteria
2. Notation of type of software program(s) used for design and layout
3. Explanation of the process used to create the item
4. Notation of all fonts, images, and ideas that are completely original for that design component
5. Citation of all ideas, fonts, and images from sources other than the designer, and/or that are copyrighted.

E. Copyright information

1. Student Copyright Checklist (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); one (1) page.
2. Photo/Film/Video Consent and Release forms. If the entry contains images of people (minors require parental consent), proof of consent must be included for each person (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); pages as needed

F. Resources and AI Reflection

1. Resources and AI Reflection (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); maximum of four (4) pages

G. Promotional Design Portfolio must be submitted as a single, multi-page PDF file with the file name "Promotional Design Portfolio" and the individual student ID number. The portfolio should consist of the following components:

1. Title Page – with the event title, the conference city and state, the individual ID number, and the year; one (1) page
2. Annual Theme/Problem Requirement Item #1; one (1) page
3. Supporting documentation for required item #1; maximum of three (3) pages
4. Annual Theme/Problem Requirement Item #2; one (1) page
5. Supporting documentation for required item #2; maximum three (3) pages
6. Annual Theme/Problem Requirement Item #3; one (1) page
7. Supporting documentation for required item #3; maximum of three (3) pages
8. Annual Theme/Problem Requirement Item #4 one (1) page
9. Supporting documentation for required item #4; maximum of three (3) pages
10. Student Copyright Checklist (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); one (1) page
11. Photo/Film/Video Consent and Release forms, if needed (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); pages as needed
12. Resources and AI Reflection (see 2027 & 2028 Forms Appendix); maximum of four (4) pages

H. All components of the chapter's entry must be finished, submitted, and accessible via the Internet by 11:59 p.m. ET on a designated date in mid-May.

SEMIFINAL ROUND

A. Semifinalists report at the time and location provided in the conference program to complete the on-site layout and design challenge with-in the one (1) hour time limit.

B. Participants are required to bring:

1. One (1) laptop. Laptop must be fully charged with enough battery for the duration of the semifinal round.
2. One (1) computer mouse (if desired).
3. Pencils and/or Pens.
4. Notebook paper or copier paper.
5. Portable power bank (if desired).

C. Participants do NOT have access to electrical power/outlets during the event; however, they may choose to bring a portable power bank.

D. Clip art may be used for the on-site challenge, but the use of a template is not permitted. Students are responsible for providing their own graphic library.

E. On-site work must be an original creation.

F. Internet access is permitted, but it will not be provided by TSA. TSA cannot guarantee the availability of cellular and/or Wi-Fi signals in the competition room.

G. Students save the design solution for the on-site problem as a PDF and submit their design solution using the submission procedures provided by the event coordinator.

H. Participants may leave the room only with permission from the event coordinator.

EVALUATION

PRELIMINARY ROUND

A. Promotional design portfolio

SEMIFINAL ROUND

A. Semifinalist problem

Refer to the official rating form for more information.

GENERATIVE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) is permitted for this event. Refer to the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) for Competitive Events found in the General Rules and Regulations.

STEM INTEGRATION

This event aligns with the STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) educational standards.

LEADERSHIP AND 21ST CENTURY SKILLS

This event provides opportunity for students to build and develop leadership and 21st century skills including but not limited to – Communication, Collaboration/Social Skills, Initiative, Problem Solving/Risk Taking, Critical Thinking, Perseverance/Grit, Creativity, Relationship Building/Teamwork, Dependability/Integrity, and Flexibility/Adaptability

CAREERS RELATED TO THIS EVENT

This competition has connections to one (1) or more of the careers below:

- Advertising executive
- Graphic designer
- Marketing manager
- Printer
- Public relations manager

Participant/Team ID# _____

PROMOTIONAL DESIGN

2027 & 2028 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

HIGH SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

☐ PDF of the Promotional Design Portfolio was submitted

☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

PROMOTIONAL DESIGN PORTFOLIO (50 points)				
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	Record scores in the column spaces below.
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio has most components and is generally organized per the order of the event guide listing; it has sufficient content.	All components are included in the portfolio; content and organization per the order of the event guide listing are excellent.	
Demonstration of Theme (X1)	Documentation does not show a clearly defined interpretation of the given theme	Documentation demonstrates an average interpretation of the given theme.	Documentation demonstrates an exceptional interpretation of the theme.	
Appropriateness of Graphic Products (X1)	Graphic products have little connection to the intent of the folder's target audience.	Graphic products are appropriate to the intended audience and have generally useful content.	Graphic products clearly connect with the intention of the promotional packet and its intended audience, providing useful, related content	
Grammar/Spelling (X1)	Many misspelled words are present, and grammar is poor.	Spelling and grammar are mostly correct.	Proper grammar and spelling are evident.	
Resources and AI Reflection (X1)	Form is incomplete or vague and does not clearly explain whether or how AI was used, showing little connection to the submission or understanding of effectiveness and ethics.	Form is complete and clearly explains AI use or the lack thereof with connections to the submission or theme/topic (when applicable), addressing effectiveness and ethical considerations with adequate analysis.	Form is complete, concise, and specific, critically evaluating how AI or non-AI tools shaped decisions and outcomes, with strong alignment to the submission or theme/topic (when applicable) and ethical reasoning.	
			PROMOTIONAL DESIGN PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (50 points)	

PRELIMINARY PROMOTIONAL DESIGN ELEMENTS (60 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
First Impressions (sharp, clean edges of graphics and fonts; entry is clear of smudges, smears, pencil or other extraneous marks) (X1)	Design is messy and/or damaged and leaves an unfavorable impression; design has little connection in conveying the design challenge	Design has a general connection to the challenge; design is neat with adequate attention to detail.	Design is eye-catching and compelling and effectively addresses the theme.	
Unity of Design (X1)	Complete packet has little obvious unity of design throughout the included items.	Complete packet demonstrates a general sense of unity of design throughout the included items.	Complete packet demonstrates an obvious unity of design that repeats throughout the included items.	
Incorporation of Graphic Design Principles (alignment, contrast, unity, white space, balance, and proportion) (X1)	Graphic products incorporate or embody few, if any, of the design principles.	Graphic products are somewhat pleasing but may be missing one (1) or two (2) design principles; products have a layout that is generally aesthetically pleasing.	Graphic products are clearly unique and aesthetically pleasing, with all graphic design principles incorporated in the overall design and layout.	
Graphic Images (X1)	Images have little connection to the essence of the challenge; logo(s) are poorly placed or of poor quality.	Images have general connections to the challenge; logo(s) are present.	Images are appropriate and effectively address the challenge; logo(s) are present and appropriately placed.	
Use of Color (X1)	Graphic has less than three (3) colors; colors used clash or distract from the graphic.	Graphic has three (3) colors, and they generally work well together.	Effective choice of colors creates an appealing graphic.	
Fonts (readable, have eye appeal, appropriate dimension and placement) (X1)	Font choice, text size, and placement are ineffective in creating an aesthetically pleasing design.	Font choice is appropriate and incorporated somewhat effectively in the design.	Font choice and size are appropriate, and the location of text is effectively incorporated in the aesthetics of the design.	
			PRELIMINARY PROMOTIONAL DESIGN ELEMENTS SUBTOTAL (60 points)	

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (110 points)

SEMIFINAL PROBLEM (50 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Layout and Design (X1)	Design inadequately incorporates the design principles of alignment, consistency, contrast, unity, or white space.	Design incorporates most design principles; overall layout is generally aesthetically pleasing.	An aesthetically pleasing design is provided, with all design principles incorporated in the layout and design.	
Solution to Project (X2)	Three (3) or more attributes of the solution's criteria are missing; leadership and/or 21st century skills are not evident.	Most attributes of the solution's criteria are included; leadership and/or 21st century skills are somewhat evident.	All attributes of the solution's criteria are evident; leadership and/or 21st century skills are clearly evident.	
Effectiveness (X1)	Solution inadequately conveys the intended message, and/or it contains unrelated text/graphics.	Solution conveys the intended message appropriately, and it uses text and/or graphics generally well.	Solution's message is easily understood and interpreted, with exceptional use of related graphics and text.	
Originality (X1)	Finished product is ordinary, plain, and unimaginative in design.	Finished product shows some effort to be imaginative and original.	Final product is truly unique and shows creativity.	
			SEMIFINAL PROBLEM SUBTOTAL (50 points)	

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____	
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (50 points)	
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. **TOTAL** (160 points)	

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____

PROMOTIONAL DESIGN
EVENT COORDINATOR INSTRUCTIONS

PERSONNEL

A. Event coordinator

B. Judges:

1. Preliminary round, two (2) or more
2. Semifinal round, two (2) or more

MATERIALS

A. Coordinator's packet, containing:

1. Event guidelines, one (1) copy for the coordinator and for each judge
2. TSA Event Coordinator Report
3. Stick-on labels for entries, as needed

B. One (1) copy on an on-site problem for each member and one (1) copy for each judge

C. Stopwatch

D. One (1) laptop to judge the semifinalists submissions. Laptop must have WiFi and be capable of opening and viewing a PDF from the online submission.

RESPONSIBILITIES

AT THE CONFERENCE

A. Attend the mandatory coordinator's meeting at the designated time and location.

B. Report to the CRC room and check the contents of the coordinator's packet.

C. Review the event guidelines and check to see that enough judges/assistants have been scheduled.

D. Inspect the area or room in which the event is to be held for appropriate set-up, including room size, chairs, tables, outlets, etc. Notify the event manager of any potential problems.

E. At least one (1) hour before the event is to begin, meet with judges and assistants to review time limits, procedures, regulations, evaluation, and all other details related to the event. If questions arise that cannot be answered, speak to the event manager before the event begins.

F. Ensure the judges have access to the online judging system.

EVENT CHECK-IN

A. Check in the entries at the time and place stated in the conference program.

B. Participants check in a standard 10" x 13" envelope containing the entry and required forms. Contents are not removed from the envelope at check-in.

C. Late entries are considered on a case-by-case basis and only when the delay is caused by events beyond participant control.

D. In order to compete, participants must be on the entry list or must have CRC approval.

E. If check-in is on the first day of the conference, requirements for attire do NOT apply during check-in.

F. Place an entry number in the upper right-hand corner of the portfolio.

G. Secure the entries in the designated area.

PRELIMINARY ROUND

A. Judges independently evaluate each entry.

B. Decisions about rules violations must be discussed and verified with the judges, event coordinator, and CRC manager to determine either:

1. To deduct twenty percent (20%) of the total possible points in this round or
2. To disqualify the entry

The event coordinator, judges, and CRC manager must initial either of these actions on the rating form.

SEMIFINAL ROUND

A. Inspect the area(s) in which the on-site activity is being held for appropriate set-up, including room size, chairs, tables, outlets, etc. Notify the event manager of any potential problems.

B. At least one (1) hour before the event is to begin, meet with your judges for the on-site activity to review time limits, procedures, regulations, evaluation, and all other details related to the event. If questions arise that cannot be answered, speak to the event manager before the event begins.

C. Semifinalists report for the on-site problem.

D. Begin the event at the scheduled time by closing the doors and checking the entry list.

   1. All semifinalists and judges should be in the room at this time.

   2. Semifinalists not present may be disqualified.

E. Judges monitor the participants during the on-site activity.

F. Monitor the judges as they individually judge the semifinal solutions.

G. Discuss rule violations (e.g. 20% deduction, disqualification) and have all relevant parties initial the rating form.

H. If necessary, manage security and the removal of materials from the event area.